

Humayun's tomb

The first example of Mughal architecture in India was the Tomb of Humayun (1508–56), the second Mughal emperor. Built in Delhi, it was commissioned by his widow, Bega Begum (1511–82), who was also buried there. Designed and built by the Persian architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas, it was also the first Mughal structure to use red sandstone on such a scale. Construction began in 1566 and continued under the reign of Humayun's son, Akbar the Great (1542–1605).

White marble was used for cladding, flooring, lattice screens (*jaalis*), door frames, eaves (*chhajja*), and for the double-shelled main dome, which stands 47 metres (154 ft) high and 91 metres (299 ft) wide. Set on a high, square platform, the tomb is the focal point of a garden divided formally into four quarters, each of which is then subdivided into nine. This quartered garden is a Persian representation of paradise, with flat surfaces separated by ornamental streams, paved pathways and avenues of trees. Humayun's tomb directly inspired the design of the Taj Mahal.

